DECOLONIZATION AND EMERGENCE OF THE THIRD WORLD

The end of Second World War witnessed a complete change in the international scenario. Not only did the globe witness a tussle between the capitalist world, led by the United States and communist bloc led by the Soviet Union, but also there were major upheavals in the Third World. There was a continuous struggle for liberation from the colonial masters to seek political as well as economic independence from the European imperialist powers.

By the end of the eighteenth century, the Third World struggle for independence became manifest in many countries. History provides numerous examples of such movements, for instance, the Tupac Amaru revolt in Bolivia and Peru, the Pontiac rebellion in North America, and the Great Slave Revolt in Haiti against the Spanish, British and French colonial powers. Among other examples, the Indian Sepoy Mutiny, the Save the Emperor Movement in Vietnam, the Boxer Rebellion in China and others show the growing resistance to the growing European incursions in the early nineteenth and twentieth centuries. Nationalist movements further matured between 1914 and 1945 as traditionalist leaders like chiefs or royal princes were replaced by nationalist leaders who were equipped with western education and ideology. Thus, the colonies once the prized possession of the colonial masters now became the real burden of White men.

Such struggles for independence in the Third World, in principle however, received support from both the Soviet Union and the United States. The Soviet perspective considered such struggle for national independence as progressive and constricted the field of operation of imperialism and monopoly capitalism. Thus, there was a growing support for national liberation movements in the Third World by the Soviet Union. The United States, in principle, opposed colonialism in the name of democracy and the right to self-determination. But the real intention was market driven. The colonies were part of the trading blocs, which hampered the progress of US trade and investment. Therefore, post-1945, the US position was tempered by strategies of tackling the ongoing weakness of their European allies, containment of communism and threats to the US